PLATFORM OVERVIEW

Knowledge Ocean User Guide

Methodological guidance for scholarly retrieval and bibliographic documentation.

Scope of the service

The platform provides a unified interface for searching scholarly sources, examining bibliographic metadata, matching DOI identifiers, and preparing downloadable reports. Results should be interpreted in relation to source coverage, metadata quality, and access entitlements.

Initial search procedure

Define the research topic using specific concepts, then select publication years, sources, and document types. A small initial result set supports assessment of relevance before the retrieval scope is expanded.

Examples across disciplines

Suitable topics include artificial intelligence in healthcare, climate change and biodiversity, energy storage, digital learning, inflation and economic growth, and cultural heritage with digital archives.

Platform credits

Each requested record reserves one credit, or two when abstracts are requested. Guests receive 50 daily credits, while Access Code holders receive 250. The current allowance is displayed in the page header and renews at midnight in Baghdad.

Structure of this guide

The following sections address query construction, access and personal keys, result assessment and reports, identifier matching and references, and finally history, privacy, and procedural troubleshooting.

RETRIEVAL STRATEGY

Constructing and refining a query

A retrieval strategy should be guided by the research question rather than result volume alone.

Search modes

Keyword mode supports topics and concepts; author mode accepts names in Latin characters; exact-phrase mode targets a specified wording. The identifier hub supports direct DOI resolution and title-to-DOI matching.

Boolean relationships

AND combines concepts, OR includes synonyms or alternatives, and NOT excludes specified terms. Parentheses define groups, while quotation marks preserve the sequence of words in a phrase.

Environmental-science example

"climate change" AND (biodiversity OR ecosystems)

Disciplinary variation

Education queries may combine digital learning with student engagement; economics queries may examine inflation and growth; engineering queries may address renewable energy and storage; humanities queries may connect heritage with digital archives.

Filters and scope

Enter publication years in chronological order and select papers, books, or both. Document-type filters distinguish reviews, meta-analyses, original research, and conference papers. Include preprints when appropriate to the study design.

Retrieval time limits

Collection allows 10 seconds per requested record within the available quota, or at most 3 hours for all available results. It stops after 5 minutes without a new, unique matching record, when the requested count is met, or when sources are exhausted; the earliest limit applies. Queueing and report generation are additional. Retrieval may yield fewer records than requested.

SOURCE ACCESS

Access management and Elsevier keys

Platform access and external-source entitlements are distinct.

Access Code

The sign-in dialog activates an Access Code and manages the browser session. The available allowance appears in the page header. Log Out ends the session and returns the interface to guest mode; removing an Elsevier key is a separate action.

Personal API key

Guests, Access Code holders, and signed-in users may use a personal Elsevier key. Enter it in the optional field within Sign In and select Save Key in Browser. Signing in is not required to save or use the key.

Use in retrieval

The personal key accompanies Scopus search requests and enables inclusion of Scopus in comprehensive searches. Platform credits and account classification remain unchanged; an external-source key does not alter the platform allowance.

Conservative requests for free accounts

Requests use basic STANDARD metadata and no more than 25 records per call. Scopus calls are conservatively spaced. Hidden transport retries, paid services, and subscription-only abstract requests are not performed.

Quota and entitlements

Allowance information is read from Elsevier responses. Requests stop when quota is exhausted until its reset time. Access denials and rate limits are reported explicitly. Data availability depends on key activation and licensing; a free account does not guarantee unrestricted access.

Storage and protection

The key remains in the current browser and is not stored in task records or reports. It is transmitted over HTTPS to the server for the Elsevier request. Remove Key deletes the saved value; signing out alone does not remove it.

ASSESSMENT OF OUTPUTS

Reviewing records and reports

Retrieved metadata should undergo critical and bibliographic assessment before reuse.

Task status

Progress indicators distinguish retrieval, record assessment, and report preparation. Stopping displays the final retrieved count and requires a choice: retain the results for viewing and PDF generation, or discard the search. No report is produced for an empty result set.

Metadata inspection

Review titles, authors, years, journals, and source attribution. The results explorer supports document filtering and searching within the current list by title, author, or journal.

Limits of automated classification

Classifications derive from provider metadata. Absence of a preprint label does not establish peer review, and an open-access label does not guarantee a direct PDF. The publisher record should substantiate publication type and access status.

Abstracts and full text

Abstract mode includes material supplied under source entitlements. Scopus basic metadata may not include an abstract. Platform reports are not copies of publisher articles and do not grant access to restricted full text.

Downloads and exports

A download control appears after completion. Depending on access classification, output may be a PDF report or a ZIP containing reports and reference exports. Files should be opened and examined for completeness before use.

Credit reconciliation

Invalid requests are rejected before charging. Unused credits are reconciled after normal completion or export failure. User-requested stopping or cancellation retains the charged allowance, whether the results are preserved or discarded.

BIBLIOGRAPHIC DOCUMENTATION

Identifier matching and references

Document identity should be established through complete bibliographic comparison.

Direct identifier resolution

Enter a DOI or its full link in the identifier hub. Review the returned study, journal, authors, year, and reference links. Some fields may remain absent from the source metadata.

Title matching

Use the full title where possible and compare candidate records against authors, year, and journal. Similarity is supporting evidence rather than definitive identification; comparable titles may refer to different studies or versions.

Examples of title-based searches

Titles may concern digital learning, biodiversity, economic transformation, or cultural archiving. Remove additions that are not part of the original title, including filenames and download-format descriptions.

Citation formats

Result cards support APA citation copying or BibTeX data when available. Verify names, title, year, volume, issue, pages, and identifier before inclusion in a scholarly article or thesis.

Incomplete fields

Consult the publisher or repository record for missing authors, dates, or identifiers. Missing information should not be supplied by conjecture. Distinguish a metadata landing page from a full-text document.

Suggested documentation sequence

Formulate the research question, execute and refine the retrieval strategy, assess relevance and bibliographic identity, and then export references. Maintain local copies of reports and references that have been reviewed.

CONTINUITY AND PRIVACY

History, responsible use, and troubleshooting

Local copies should be retained for outputs required in subsequent research.

Retrieving previous work

Refresh history to display packages, then reopen results or download reports. Access depends on the browser session. Report files are deleted automatically after 48 hours, so important outputs should be downloaded promptly.

Service data

Queries, results, and task metadata are stored on the server to support history. Credit and IP data support usage limits and sign-in protection. Deleting report files does not necessarily remove all database records at the same time.

Sparse results or slow execution

Reconsider terminology, synonyms, exclusions, and publication years. Relax strict title filtering or select another source where appropriate. Other providers may continue when one source fails, accompanied by an explanatory notice.

Scopus restrictions

For an access denial, verify that Scopus access is enabled for the key. When quota is exhausted, wait for the provider's reported reset time. Alternative credentials are not substituted automatically to evade personal-key restrictions.

Persistence of the key

Persistence requires the same browser and permission to store site data. Private browsing or clearing site data may remove a saved key. Use Remove Key when retention is no longer desired, particularly on shared devices.

Ending a session

Download required reports and verify citations, then use Log Out in the page header to end the session. The handbook defaults to the interface language when the page opens or its language changes; Arabic or English may also be selected manually.

OUTPUT MANAGEMENT

Large reports and stop decisions

Complete records are retained while individual files remain manageable.

Background report preparation

Comprehensive searches prepare report parts on the server during retrieval. Parts affected by metadata changes are refreshed before packaging, using the same report format.

PDF content limit

No PDF may exceed 500,000 words, including its displayed text. Parts are divided only between complete records. A publication or its abstract is never distributed across two files.

An exceptionally large source

If one source alone cannot fit within the limit, the complete source is retained in one separate text file in the archive with an explicit notice. It is neither divided nor truncated to fit a PDF.

Opening the complete index

The archive contains manageable PDF index parts, a complete CSV index and an HTML file guide. Extract the archive before opening the file guide and selecting the required parts.

Choosing after stopping

The notification gives the final retrieved publication count. The first option retains the results for viewing and PDF generation; the second permanently discards the search results and temporary files. The charged quota is retained in both cases.